

ID.3 Inspection Sequence & Clocks

Four inspection tracks over one Idaho house, the clocks the statute puts on every one of them, and the one that starts before the footings.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Idaho's Building Code Act does not put a private house under a building permit by itself — it authorizes each city and county to adopt and enforce a code, and where none has, there is no residential building permit, plan review, inspection or certificate of occupancy. The state Division of Occupational and Professional Licenses (DOPL) issues no building permit for a house. What does not depend on any of that: the electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits, which are statewide; the health-district septic permit; and the IDWR well drilling permit. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. The trade inspection ladders below are the state rules'. A city or county running its own program sets its own; an enforcing jurisdiction's building inspections follow IRC R109 as its ordinance adopted it. Ask, and write the answer on the log at the end.

WHAT YOU GET DEPENDS ON WHETHER ANYONE ADOPTED A CODE

ID.1 settled whether your city or county enforces a building code. Here is what each answer means once the concrete moves. **Read across the trade columns.** They are the same in both rows, and that is the point Idaho owner-builders most often miss.

Two answers, four tracks

Your status	Who inspects the BUILDING	Who inspects the TRADES
Enforcing jurisdiction	The local building department, on IRC R109 as adopted and amended by its ordinance, ending in a certificate of occupancy under R110	DOPL — separate permits, separate inspectors, separate tags — unless the city or county runs its own program for that trade
No building code adopted	Nobody. No building permit, no footing or framing inspection, no certificate of occupancy. Nobody offers a voluntary one either — DOPL issues no residential permit	DOPL. Still required. Electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits and inspections do not depend on the Building Code Act at all

Building: Idaho Code Title 39, Chapter 41 (§ 39-4111, § 39-4116). Electrical, plumbing and HVAC: Title 54, Chapters 10, 26 and 50 (§ 54-1005, § 54-2620, § 54-5016). Septic and the well are a fifth and sixth track — the health district and IDWR — and come at the end of this document.

THE FIRST DECISION — TEMPORARY POWER, THREE WAYS

Your power supplier "shall not connect with or energize any electrical installation ... unless an inspection has been conducted and resulted as 'passed'" (§ 54-1005(3)); the only exception is a connection "after the purchase of an electrical permit by a licensed electrical contractor," which the rule confines to preserving life or property and "temporary service for construction" — "at the request of a licensed electrical contractor" (IDAPA 24.39.10.200.04). On a homeowner permit that door is shut. Decide before the footings:

Three ways to get power on site

	Option	How it works
A	A licensed electrical contractor pulls the permit for the temporary service	The utility energizes on the contractor's request before inspection; the contractor "assumes full responsibility." Your homeowner permit covers the house wiring separately
B	You build the temporary service on your homeowner permit	Request the inspection; the utility may set the meter only after it passes. The 48-business-hour clock below applies. Nothing may be concealed before approval for cover
C	Generator until the permanent service passes	No utility involvement until the final. Note (4): nobody but a power supplier may energize an installation before a permit is bought — buy the permit first either way

THE CLOCKS THE STATUTE GIVES YOU

Idaho wrote three of these in 2025 and 2026, and they are the most useful pages in this kit if an office goes quiet on you.

Deadlines the office owes you

Clock	What the statute says	Cite
Completeness — 10 business days	If a residential building permit application "is deemed incomplete, the local government shall, within ten (10) business days of receipt ... provide written notice to the applicant specifying any missing information." Each resubmission gets another 10 business days for a written completeness determination — which "shall not constitute approval" but sends the application to formal plan review	§ 39-4117(2), (3)
Extension only in writing	The clock moves only if you "agree in writing to an extension," and first "a local government shall provide written notice to an applicant explaining that an extension is needed"	§ 39-4117(4)
Plan review — no clock for a house	The 30-calendar-day initial-review deadline in the Act applies to "public works" and public school plans only. There is no statutory plan-review deadline for a private residence	§ 39-4113(2), (6)

Deadlines the office owes you

Clock	What the statute says	Cite
Which law governs	"Permits shall be governed by the laws in effect at the time the permit application is received"	§ 39-4116(6)
Failure with no reason — 10% back	If an inspector fails the work and "fails to, within three (3) business days, provide the permit holder or his agent with a reason for the failure," the jurisdiction "shall refund ten percent (10%)" of the inspection fee. Same rule on all four tracks	§ 39-4118(2); § 54-1004A(2); § 54-2626A(2); § 54-5020A(2)

The 48-business-hour rule — one sentence, four statutes, and a self-help remedy

"If an inspection requested by a permit holder **is not performed within forty-eight (48) business hours**, such permit holder shall be authorized to **hire a third-party inspector** to perform such inspection. The permit holder or third-party inspector shall notify the division or local government that such inspection is being completed by a third-party inspector. The permit holder shall provide a copy of the results of the completed inspection to the division or local government. A permit holder who obtains a third-party inspection under this section **shall be refunded any fee**, or portion thereof, that the permit holder paid ... for such inspection."

The text is identical in § 39-4118(1) (building, effective 1 July 2025) and in § 54-1004A(1) (electrical), § 54-2626A(1) (plumbing) and § 54-5020A(1) (HVAC), all effective 1 July 2026. The third-party inspector must hold the same credential as the state's: ICC certification for building (§ 39-4108), and the electrical, plumbing and HVAC qualifications the trade chapters set for their own inspectors. **Log the date and time of every request** — the log at the end has the column — because the clock runs from the request.

THE TRADE LADDERS, AS THE RULES FIX THEM

Each DOPL inspection ends in a **tag** attached to the work. The tags are the record; keep them on until the final.

Three ladders, three rules

Track	The rungs, quoted	Cite
Plumbing	Groundwork — "for groundwork to be covered, with acceptance by the inspector," tag "preferably to a vertical riser" → rough-in — "prior to covering or concealing" → final — "when the plumbing as specified on the permit is complete"	IDAPA 24.39.20.500.03

Three ladders, three rules

Track	The rungs, quoted	Cite
HVAC	Work-in-progress — "following inspection of groundwork, rough-in work, or any portion of the installation that is to be covered or otherwise concealed" → final . A "Notice of Correction" tag means a reinspection and a reinspection fee. Notify DOPL "at least one (1) day prior to the desired inspection, Sundays and holidays excluded"	IDAPA 24.39.70.500.03; § 54-5020(1)
Electrical	Cover — "No wiring or equipment may be concealed in any manner from access or sight until the work has been inspected and approved for cover" → final , which is what unlocks the meter. A correction notice "shall clearly indicate any and all violations to be corrected and specify a definite period of time"	IDAPA 24.39.10.500.01.a.i; § 54-1005(3); § 54-1004

Booking. Every DOPL form says it in capitals: "THIS PERMIT APPLICATION IS NOT AN INSPECTION REQUEST." Requests go through DOPL's eTRAKiT portal, linked from each trade's permit page — "requests for a next day inspection can be made until 7 p.m. MST" — or the inspection phone line using the code for the inspection type: plumbing **203** groundwork, **201** rough-in, **204** final; HVAC **701** rough-in, **713** gas pressure, **704** final. The assigned inspector and his inspection days for your city are on DOPL's Inspector List with Schedules (ID.4). Post the orange Job Identification Sticker where the inspector will see it. Combined permits: a DOPL plumbing or HVAC permit that "includes any part of an electrical installation" satisfies the electrical chapter if the fees are paid (§ 54-1016(4); § 54-5016(2)).

THE BUILDING INSPECTIONS — IRC R109 AS YOUR ORDINANCE ADOPTED IT

No Idaho statute or rule enumerates the residential building inspections. In an enforcing jurisdiction, IRC R109 governs as the local ordinance adopted it — and Part I, where R109 lives, is one of the parts a local government may amend by ordinance (§ 39-4116(4)(c)(i)). The model code's list is the default: foundation; plumbing, mechanical and electrical rough (where the local program does them); floodplain elevation where applicable; frame and masonry; final.

Ask for the jurisdiction's own list — the § 39-4117(1) process document should carry it — and expect it to be longer.

Around the building inspections

	The rule	Cite
Who may inspect	State and local building inspectors hold ICC certification; one with only the residential certification "may only inspect structures regulated by the International Residential Code"	§ 39-4108
Virtual re-inspections	Allowed "at their discretion" after an in-person inspection; the address must be verified on camera; not for structural inspections on buildings of three stories or more	§ 39-4119

Around the building inspections

	The rule	Cite
Certificate of occupancy	IRC R110 as adopted, locally amendable. Where no building code is enforced, none exists and none can be requested — plan for a lender or insurer to ask, and keep every trade tag and the septic as-built instead	—
Appeals	Local: the IRC R112 board of appeals as the ordinance adopted it. The state Building Code Board hears appeals only for buildings "within the jurisdiction of the division" — not a house in an enforcing county. Trade correction notices: the chapters give the boards appeals of civil penalties only; ask the inspector's area supervisor in writing	§ 39-4107(2); § 39-4120

SEPTIC AND WELL — THE OTHER TWO TRACKS

Health district and IDWR

	The rule	Cite
Septic — site and test holes	"If an inspection requires preparation, such as test hole excavation or partial construction of the system, the applicant or permittee must notify the Director at least forty-eight (48) hours in advance, excluding weekends and holidays"	IDAPA 58.01.03.011.03
Septic — final	"No system may receive wastewater until the Director conducts a final installation inspection and completes as-built drawings"; the as-built comes to you within 30 days. The permittee must uncover anything covered before inspection on request	IDAPA 58.01.03.011.05, .011.02
Well — driller's report	The driller keeps a daily log at the well site and files the report with IDWR "within thirty (30) days following the completion of the well"	§ 42-238(11)

INSPECTION LOG — RECORD EVERY REQUEST AND EVERY TAG

Every visit, whoever required it — the "Requested" date starts the 48-business-hour clock

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Septic site / test-hole inspection — 48 hours' notice. Requested _____ Done _____ Result _____		
☐	Temporary service — option A, B or C above, and the date the meter was set. Option _____ Inspected _____ Meter set _____		
☐	Foundation / footing — local, if a building code is enforced. Requested _____ Done _____ Result _____		
☐	Plumbing groundwork — DOPL code 203, before cover. Requested _____ Done _____ Tag _____		
☐	HVAC work-in-progress — anything to be concealed. Requested _____ Done _____ Tag _____		
☐	Plumbing rough-in — code 201, before concealment. Requested _____ Done _____ Tag _____		
☐	Electrical cover — nothing concealed until approved. Requested _____ Done _____ Result _____		

Every visit, whoever required it — the "Requested" date starts the 48-business-hour clock

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Frame — local, if enforced. Envelope method: visual inspection items field-verified, or blower door booked. Requested _____ Done _____ Result _____		
☐	Gas pressure test — HVAC code 713; 20 psig for 20 minutes. Requested _____ Done _____ Tag _____		
☐	Electrical final — unlocks the meter. Requested _____ Done _____ Result _____		
☐	Plumbing final — code 204. HVAC final — code 704. Plumbing tag _____ HVAC tag _____		
☐	Septic final and as-built received — no wastewater before this. Done _____ As-built received _____		
☐	Building final and certificate of occupancy , if issued where I am building. Final _____ CO number _____		
☐	Any inspection my jurisdiction requires that is not on this list — ask, and write it here: Inspection _____ Date _____		

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at legislature.idaho.gov → Idaho Statutes, one section per page (.../idstat/Title54/T54CH10/SECT54-1016/), each ending with a History line naming every session law that amended it. Rules are at adminrules.idaho.gov, one PDF per IDAPA chapter (.../rules/current/24/243910.pdf), every paragraph carrying its own effective date. **One warning:** DOPL is not your building department — its own form says so. Read September 2026.